

ENG518

1. Research

A systematic inquiry aimed at discovering, interpreting, or revising facts, theories, or applications. It involves formulating a research question, collecting data, analyzing it, and deriving conclusions.

2. Hypothesis

A tentative statement predicting a relationship between two or more variables. It provides a focus for research and can be tested for validity.

3. Variables

Factors or elements that can change or vary in a study. They are used to measure the relationship or impact of one element on another.

4. Independent Variable

The variable that is manipulated or controlled by the researcher to observe its effect on the dependent variable.

5. Dependent Variable

The outcome or the variable being tested and measured. Its changes depend on the independent variable.

6. Moderator Variable

A variable that influences the strength or direction of the relationship between an independent and a dependent variable.

7. Control Variable

Variables kept constant to ensure they do not affect the outcome of the study. They help isolate the relationship between the independent and dependent variables.

8. Intervening Variable

A hypothetical variable that explains the relationship between the independent and dependent variables. It cannot be observed directly but is inferred from the data.

9. Sampling

The process of selecting a subset of individuals from a population to represent the whole. It makes research feasible by focusing on a manageable group.

10. Population

The entire group of individuals or items being studied, from which a sample is drawn.

11. Sample

A smaller, manageable group selected from the population to conduct research. It must represent the population to generalize findings.

12. Qualitative Research

Focuses on understanding human behavior, beliefs, and experiences through non-numerical data like interviews, observations, and texts.

13. Quantitative Research

Emphasizes numerical data, statistical methods, and measuring relationships between variables.

14. Basic Research

Also known as fundamental research, it seeks to expand existing knowledge without a focus on practical applications.

15. Applied Research

Research aimed at solving specific practical problems or improving processes in real-world settings.

16. Action Research

A participatory research approach focusing on solving specific problems within a community or organization through active involvement.

17. Exploratory Research

Conducted to explore new areas where little knowledge exists, providing insights and generating hypotheses for further research.

18. Confirmatory Research

Tests a specific hypothesis or theory to confirm or refute it using established methodologies.

19. Research Problem

A specific issue or question that the researcher aims to address through their study. It guides the objectives and design of the research.

20. Research Objectives

Clear and specific goals the researcher intends to achieve. They provide direction and focus to the study.

21. Research Design

A structured plan outlining how the study will be conducted, including methods, sampling, and analysis.

22. Data Collection Procedures

Techniques used to gather information for analysis. Common methods include observations, surveys, interviews, and experiments.

23. Observational Data Gathering

Involves collecting data by observing subjects in their natural or controlled environment.

24. Instrumental Data Gathering

Uses tools like surveys, questionnaires, and tests to collect data systematically.

25. Validity

The degree to which a research instrument measures what it is intended to measure. Ensures accuracy of results.

26. Reliability

The consistency of measurement results when the same instrument or method is used repeatedly.

27. Correlation Coefficient

A statistical measure indicating the strength and direction of a relationship between two variables. Ranges from -1 to +1.

28. Primary Research

Original research conducted to collect firsthand data through methods like experiments, surveys, or interviews.

29. Secondary Research

Involves analyzing existing data collected by others, such as books, articles, or databases.

30. Research Paradigms

Frameworks or approaches guiding research, including positivism, constructivism, and pragmatism.

31. Experimental Group

The group in a study that receives the treatment or intervention being tested.

32. Control Group

The group that does not receive the treatment or intervention. Used as a baseline to compare results.

33. Literature Review

A summary and evaluation of existing research on a topic, identifying gaps and justifying the study's purpose.

34. Position Paper

A written report presenting an argument or viewpoint on a specific issue, often based on prior research.

35. Research Ethics

Standards ensuring the protection, privacy, and rights of participants. Includes informed consent and avoiding harm.

36. Internal Validity

The extent to which a study accurately establishes cause-and-effect relationships without interference from extraneous variables.

37. External Validity

The degree to which findings can be generalized to other populations or settings.

38. Null Hypothesis

A statement asserting no relationship or difference between variables. It is tested to be either accepted or rejected.

39. Directional Hypothesis

Predicts the specific direction of the relationship between variables (e.g., positive or negative).

40. Research Proposal

A detailed plan outlining the intended research, including objectives, methodology, and significance.

41. Sampling Techniques

Methods for selecting participants, such as random sampling, stratified sampling, and convenience sampling.

42. Random Sampling

A probability sampling method where every individual in the population has an equal chance of selection.

43. Stratified Sampling

Divides the population into subgroups and selects samples from each to ensure representation.

44. Convenience Sampling

Non-probability sampling where participants are selected based on availability and ease of access.

45. Purposive Sampling

Deliberate selection of participants based on specific characteristics or expertise.

46. Data Analysis

The process of interpreting data to draw conclusions. It involves organizing, summarizing, and applying statistical techniques.

47. Measurement Tools

Instruments like questionnaires, tests, or scales used to gather quantitative or qualitative data.

48. Likert Scale

A scale commonly used in surveys to measure attitudes or perceptions, with responses ranging from "strongly disagree" to "strongly agree."

49. Research Questions

Specific queries the study aims to answer, derived from the research problem.

50. Extraneous Variables

Uncontrolled variables that can influence the results of a study, potentially confounding the findings.

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Composition